could only hamper them by their red-tape and lack of imagination. Apart from certain individuals, this applied to both British and Indian members of the higher services. It was extraordinary how unfitted they were for the new tasks that faced them. There was, of course, a great deal of inefficiency and incompetence on the popular side. But it was counterbalanced by energy and enthusiasm, and close touch with masses, and a

desire and capacity to learn from one's own mistakes. **There was** vitality there, a bubbling life, a sense of tension, a desire to **get** things done, all of which contrasted strangely with the apathy **and** conservatism of the British ruling class and their supporters. India, the land of tradition, thus offered a strange picture of reversal of roles. The British, who had come here as representatives of a dynamic society, were now the chief upholders of a static, unchanging tradition; among the Indians there were many who represented the new dynamic order and were eager for change, change not **only** political but also social and economic. Behind those Indians **there** were, of course, vast new forces at work which perhaps even they hardly realized. This reversal of roles was a demonstration